BRIOCHE

MAKES	ACTIVE TIME	REST	TOTAL TIME
3 loaves, 1.6 kg of dough	**40 min**	**2 h poolish, 1 h bulk, then overnight chilled and 2 3 h in the pan**	**about 24 h**

OVEN	UNIT WEIGHT	ENERGY COST
425F for 15 min, then 350F for 45 min	**600 g**	**$2.75 (60 min bake plus 20 min preheat, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)**

INGREDIENTS

1/4 tsp	Instant yeast, for the poolish
180 ml	Water at 75F, for the poolish
150 g	Bread flour, for the poolish
1 tbsp	Instant yeast, for the dough
110 ml	Whole milk, chilled
4	Eggs, large, chilled
5	Egg yolks, large, chilled
315 g	Bread flour
185 g	All-purpose flour
50 g	Sugar
3/4 tbsp	Salt
350 g	Unsalted butter, at room temperature
4	Egg yolks, for the wash
60 ml	Heavy cream, for the wash
a pinch	Salt, for the wash

METHOD

1. Stir the poolish yeast into the water. Put the poolish flour in the bowl of a stand mixer, add the yeasted water and bring it together with a spatula. Cover and leave 2 hours at room temperature, until doubled and visibly bubbling on top.
2. While it ferments, weigh everything else out and cut the butter into 12 mm chunks.
3. Stir the dough yeast into the cold milk. Add it to the poolish bowl along with the whole eggs and the yolks, all at once. Fit the dough hook and run the mixer on its lowest speed for about a minute, just to break everything up.
4. Stop the mixer. Add both flours, the sugar and the salt together. Mix on low about 2 minutes, until a dough starts to form and no dry flour is left clinging to the side of the bowl.
5. Raise to medium-low and run 6 minutes.
6. Start dropping in the butter, one chunk at a time, without waiting between them. When it is all in, keep mixing 4 minutes.
7. Stop and scrape the bowl down, pushing any butter that has escaped back into the dough.
8. Medium speed for 8 minutes, then medium-high for one more. The dough should finish smooth and glossy.
9. Move it to a large bowl, cover, and leave 1 hour at room temperature.
10. Once doubled, turn it onto a lightly floured bench and fold it in half, then into quarters. Pat it into a round about 4 cm thick on an oiled baking sheet, dust the top with flour and wrap it.
11. Freeze at least 1 hour to drop the temperature fast and stall the ferment, then move it to the fridge overnight.
12. Butter three 23 by 12 cm loaf pans. Divide the cold dough into three. Press each piece into a rectangle as long as the pan and a little wider, roll it up tightly from a short end, pinch the seam and the ends shut, and set it seam-side down in the pan. Each pan should be no more than a third full.
13. Prove 2 to 3 hours somewhere draft-free and humid, ideally 24 to 27C. The dough should at least double and look puffy while still springing back when touched.
14. Heat the oven to 425F and give it at least 20 minutes. Ten minutes before baking, whisk the wash yolks with the cream and a pinch of salt to a pale yellow, brush it over the loaves, and let it dry about 10 minutes.
15. Bake 15 minutes, then drop to 350F and give them about 45 minutes more, until they are an even dark gold on top, sides and bottom.
16. Rap the pan bottoms on the counter to release the loaves and turn them onto racks.

NOTES

350 g of butter against 650 g of total flour is 54%, which is what puts this in the brioche mousseline bracket. Some versions run as high as 80%.
All that butter is why the dough has to be properly cold when you shape it. Let it warm and the butter starts weeping out and the dough turns sticky. Put it back in the fridge until it firms up again.
Oil your fingers lightly before shaping, otherwise the dough clings to them.
A third full is not a suggestion. The rise is substantial and a fuller pan bakes a loaf too big for it.
Same-day option: 2 hours in the freezer, then 3 to 5 hours in the fridge before shaping.
The same dough makes jam buns, bacon and egg buns, or plain loaves. The book's concha also uses it.

PRESERVING

Freeze the dough rather than the baked loaf if you know you will not bake all 1.6 kg. Baked brioche goes stale quickly for a bread this rich.
Freeze the dough after the bulk and the fold, in a wide shallow airtight container, for a few days. Thaw overnight in the fridge before shaping.
A baked loaf is good the day it is made. Past that, wrap it and refrigerate up to 3 days, then toast or warm it to serve.
Stale brioche is the start of bread pudding rather than something to throw out.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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